



sharp knife. As ripening occurs, the stems will begin to crack, the fruits will soften, and their sweet smell will grow stronger. They will keep fresh for a few weeks in the refrigerator once harvested.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Greenhouse melons are at risk from general greenhouse pests and diseases, such as spider mite and whitefly. Powdery mildew and cucumber mosaic virus can also be a problem. Combat these by practicing good garden hygiene, and ensure that plants are well-spaced and well-ventilated. Try to prevent rot by keeping stems dry.

TIP SUPPORT FRUITS

Ripening melons can become very heavy, and if you have trained your plants to climb there is a risk of fruit falling and becoming damaged. Tie netting or a string bag to the wire supports to take their weight.



Support heavy fruits with netting.